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S I M O N M U N Z E R T

academic positions

Hertie School

Professor of Data Science and Public Policy (with tenure), 2022–Present.

Director of the Hertie School Data Science Lab, 2023–Present.

Assistant Professor of Data Science and Public Policy, 2019–2022.

Lecturer in Political Data Science, 2017–2019.

International Program in Survey and Data Science, University of Mannheim & University of Maryland

Adjunct assistant professor, 2018–2020.

Humboldt University of Berlin

Postdoctoral research and teaching fellow, Department of Social Sciences, Chair of Comparative Political Behavior (Prof. Dr. Heike Klüver), 2017.

University of Mannheim

Postdoctoral research fellow; Mannheim Centre for European Social Research (MZES), 2016.

Duke University

Visiting research fellow, Department of Political Science and Ward Lab, 2014.

University of Konstanz

Stipendiary, Center for Quantitative Methods and Survey Research, 2009–2011.

education

Ph.D., Political Science (Dr. rer. soc., summa cum laude), Graduate School of Decision Sciences, University of Konstanz, 2015.

M.A., Politics and Public Administration, University of Konstanz, 2011.

B.A., Political and Administrative Science, University of Konstanz, 2009.

research grants
(external)

- Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft. 2023. "Wahlprognosen für die Bundestagswahl 2025." Together with Thomas Gschwend and Lukas Stoetzer. Total amount EUR 1.3M (Hertie School: EUR 284,565).
- KonsortSWD Projektförderung Forschungsdatenmanagement. Together with GESIS Mannheim. Total amount: EUR 25,530.
- APSIA Junior Faculty Grant. 2021. Together with Johannes Himmelreich (Maxwell School, Syracuse University). Total amount: USD 6,700.
- Facebook Research Content Governance Award. 2020. "*Global Preferences for Hate Speech Regulation*." Main principal investigator; co-principal investigator: Richard Traunmüller. Total amount: EUR 85,400.
- Stifterverband and Dieter-Schwarz-Stiftung. 2019. Innovation Hubs@Campus Finalist and Member of the Innovation Club. "*Hertie School Data Science Lab. Data Science meets Public Policy*" Together with Slava Jankin. Total amount: EUR 15,000.
- Daimler and Benz Foundation, Postgraduates and Junior Professors Fellowship Program. 2017. "*Citizen and Elite Activity on the Wikipedia Market Place of Political Information*." Total amount: EUR 40,000.
- VolkswagenStiftung. 2017. "*Paying Attention to Attention: Media Exposure and Opinion Formation in an Age of Information Overload*." Main principal investigator; co-principal investigators: Pablo Barberá, Andrew Guess, JungHwan Yang. 2017–2021. Total amount: EUR 736,600.

research and activity grants
(internal)

- Hertie School Faculty Activity Fund, AY 2023/24. Harnessing Data for the Comparative Political Legislators Database. Total amount: EUR 6,175.
- Hertie School Faculty Activity Fund, AY 2021/22. Political Economy Lunch Seminar. Total amount: EUR 13,500.
- Hertie School Faculty Activity Fund, AY 2021/22. Together with Ruth Dittmann. EuroWEPS Conference. Total amount: EUR 5,000.
- Hertie School Faculty Activity Fund, AY 2020/21 II. "*Comparative Legislators Database - Version 2.0*" Total amount: EUR 8,910.
- Hertie School Faculty Activity Fund, AY 2019/20 II. "*Fundamental Rights Trade Offs: Challenges for Governance in Times of Corona*." Main principal investigator; co-principal investigators: Anita Gohdes, Will Lowe, Başak Çalı. Total amount: EUR 26,800.
- Hertie School Faculty Activity Fund, AY 2019/20. "*Free Speech Regulation and the Politics of Hate*." Main principal investigator; co-principal investigator: Daniela Stockmann. Total amount: EUR 4,700.

Hertie School Faculty Activity Fund, AY 2018/19, second round. *“Building Indicators of Public Engagement in Health and Climate Change.”* Main principal investigator; co-principal investigator: Slava Jankin. Total amount: EUR 9,780.

Hertie School Faculty Activity Fund, AY 2018/19. *“What Should We Be Allowed to Say? Citizens’ Preferences for Hate Speech Regulation.”* Main principal investigator; co-principal investigator: Daniela Stockmann, Richard Traunmüller. Total amount: EUR 15,350.

scholarships

DFG / Excellence Initiative Research Fellowship at the Department of Political Science, Duke University (granted for five months). 2014. Total amount: EUR 6,750.

Stipendiary at the Center for Quantitative Methods and Survey Research. 2009 Total amount: approx. EUR 24,000.

awards

Hertie School Teaching Award. Academic Year 2023/24.

GOR Best Paper Award, awarded by the German Society for Online Research (together with Peter Selb, Anita Gohdes, Lukas Stoetzer, and Will Lowe) for *“Tracking and promoting the usage of a COVID-19 contact tracing app”*. 2022.

ALLBUS Award for the best paper published using data from the German General Social Survey, awarded by GESIS–Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences (together with Paul Bauer) for *“Political Depolarization in German Public Opinion, 1980-2010”*. 2014.

Best Paper Award of the German Society for Electoral Studies (DGfW), together with Peter Selb, for *“Estimating Constituency Preferences from Sparse Survey Data Using Auxiliary Geographic Information”*. 2014.

VEUK Award (Verein der Ehemaligen der Universität Konstanz) for best M.A. thesis. 2011.

invited talks

“Geographic Targeting via Social Media Ads for Election Survey Research.” DEMED Webinar Series, University of Glasgow, 2026.

“Myside bias undermines online content moderation.” CCBI seminar series, European Commission, 2026.

“Myside bias undermines online content moderation.” Content Moderation, Free Speech & Democracy Workshop, TUM Content Moderation Lab, 2026.

“What [young] people think we should be allowed to say.” CIVICA Youth Gender Polarization and Digital Fragmentation Conference, EUI, 2025.

“The Future of Democracy Research.” Keynote, MEDem Conference, GESIS Cologne, 2025.

“Global Preferences for Hate Speech Moderation.” Royal Holloway University of London, 2025.

“Measuring Public Preferences and Exposure Effects Using Synthetic Visual Conjoint.” LISER Data Science and Simulation Seminar, Luxembourg, 2024.

- “Citizen Preferences for Online Hate Speech Regulation.” Lund University, 2024.
- “Citizen Preferences for Online Hate Speech Regulation.” Workshop on Social Media and Contentious Politics. PRIO, 2023.
- “Towards a fundamental skillset of CSS for Zoomers.” Workshop Computational Social Science: Bridging Data and Methods with Theory and Applications. Bielefeld University, 2024.
- “Citizen Preferences for Online Hate Speech Regulation.” Workshop Content Moderation and Free Speech on Social Media. TU Munich, 2023.
- “Do voting advice apps empower citizens?” CSDP Symposium on Social Media and Opinion Formation, Princeton University, 2022.
- “Citizens’ Preferences for Online Hate Speech Regulation.” University of Berne, 2022.
- “Use and misuse of digital data and technologies. Digital contact tracing during the pandemic.” Hertie School practice council, 2021.
- “Making COVID-19 contact tracing more effective. Fighting the pandemic with digital tools.” Hertie School opening lecture AY 2021/22, 2021.
- “Wer nutzt die Corona-Warn-App? Tracking und Steigerung der Nutzung der COVID-19 Kontaktverfolgungs-App.” Digitales Kolloquium Soziologische Perspektiven auf die Corona-Krise, WZB, 2021.
- “Wer nutzt COVID-19-Apps? Mit digitalen Tools durch die Corona-Pandemie.” Augenblick für Forschung, Daimler and Benz Foundation, 2021.
- “How effective is Germany’s COVID-19 contact tracing app?” Hertie School Open Week Lecture, 2021.
- “Citizens’ Preferences for Online Hate Speech Regulation in the United States and Germany” LSE Political Behaviour Seminar, 2021.
- “(Wie) funktionieren eigentlich Wahlprognosen?” Stiftung der Deutschen Wirtschaft, 2021.
- “How Citizens Perceive Online Hate Speech And What They Want to Be Done About it.” Human Rights Film Festival Berlin, 2020.
- “The consequences of online partisan media.” InFER Colloquium Goethe University Frankfurt, 2020.
- “What Should We Be Allowed to Post? Citizens’ Preferences for Online Hate Speech Regulation.” Nuffield College Political Science Seminar, 2020.
- “The consequences of online partisan media.” Political Behavior Workshop, WZB, 2020.
- “Political Legacies and Public Fame: Measuring the Importance of Political Elites.” MZES, Mannheim, 2019.
- “Beyond the Crystal Ball: Scientific Forecasts of the 2017 German Federal Election.” Hertie School, 2017.

“Networks of Knowledge and the Study of Political Behavior.” Keynote speech, Graduate School of Decision Sciences, Konstanz, 2016.

“Examining a Most Likely Case for Strong Campaign Effects: Hitler’s Speeches and the Rise of the Nazi Party, 1927–1933.” University of Mannheim, 2016.

“Measuring Public Attention using Wikipedia Access Statistics.” ZU Friedrichshafen, 2015.

“Are Voters Really Sensitive to Weather Conditions? Turnout at German Federal Elections under the Meteorological Microscope.” Lange Nacht der Wissenschaft, Konstanz, 2012.

“Estimating Constituency Preferences from Sparse Survey Data Using Auxiliary Geographic Information.” SciencePo Paris, 2012.

workshops
and
events

“Der Daten Life-Cycle – Vom Rohstoff zur KI-Anwendung.” Hertie School, Berlin, 2024.

“Data Science and Evidence-Based Policy-Making.” Tbilisi, Georgia, 2024.

“European Workshop in Empirical Political Science.” Hertie School, Berlin, 2022.

“Teaching Data Science for Non-Data Scientists and Data Ethics for Non-Ethicists.” Hertie School, Berlin, 2021.

“Praxisworkshop Data Science und Digitalisierung.” Hertie School, 2021.

“Leveraging data science to forecast the 2021 German federal election – more than just polling.” Hertie School, 2021.

“Free Speech Regulation and the Politics of Hate.” Hertie School, Berlin, 2020.

“A Primer to Web Scraping with R.” Campus Lucerne, 2019.

“Comparative Research on Political Elites.” Hertie School, Berlin, 2019.

“A Primer to Web Scraping with R.” Max-Planck-Institut für Gesellschaftsforschung, Cologne, 2019.

“A Primer to Web Scraping with R.” Cologne Center for Comparative Politics, 2018.

“Web Scraping and APIs.” Joint Program in Survey Methodology, Bureau of Labor Statistics, Washington, DC, 2018.

“Political Economy in the Computational Age.” Hertie School, Berlin, 2018.

“A Primer to Web Scraping and Text Mining with R.” Geschwister Scholl Institute, Ludwig Maximilian University of Munich, 2018.

“Citizen and Elite Activity on Wikipedia.” Hertie School, Berlin, 2017.

“Media Exposure and Opinion Formation.” USC, Los Angeles, 2017.

“International Research in Computational Social Sciences.” GESIS Cologne, 2017.

“Election Forecasting with R.” University of Konstanz, 2017.

- “A Primer to Web Scraping with R.” AAPOR Webinar, 2017.
- “A Primer to Web Scraping with R.” European University Institute, Florence, 2017.
- “A Primer on Web Scraping with R.” Joint Statistical Meetings, Chicago, 2016.
- “Empirical Economic and Social Research Workshop.” ZEW/MZES Mannheim, 2016.
- “International Research in Computational Social Sciences.” GESIS Cologne, 2016.
- “Measuring Political Knowledge in Web-Based Surveys.” GESIS Mannheim, 2015.
- “Introduction to Web Scraping with R.” Wissenschaftszentrum Berlin, 2015.
- “A Primer on Web Scraping with R.” University of Bamberg, 2015.
- “Web Scraping with R.” Workshop, Duke University, 2014.
- “Automated Data Collection in the World Wide Web with R.” University of Bern, 2014.
- “Introduction to Web Scraping with R.” University of Zurich, 2013.
- “Introduction to R and Web Scraping.” University of Mannheim, 2012.

teaching

Hertie School

Evidence-Based Decision-Making (Executive Education)

Der Daten Life-Cycle – Vom Rohstoff zur KI-Anwendung (Zertifikatsprogramm “KI und Data Science für die öffentliche Verwaltung”)

Data Journalism (MPP, MIA, MDS)

Introduction to Data Science (MPP, MIA, MDS)

Statistics II: Statistical Modeling and Causal Inference (MPP, MIA)

Statistics II: Time-Series, Panel Data & Maximum Likelihood Estimation (MPP, MIA)

Election Forecasting (MPP)

Web Data Collection and Social Media Mining (MPP, MIA)

Data Literacy in the Digital Age (EMPA)

Der Daten Life-Cycle – Vom Rohstoff zur KI-Anwendung (EMPA)

International Program in Survey and Data Science

A Primer to Web Scraping with R (professionals)

Humboldt University

Methods of Election Forecasting (undergraduate level; in German)

Web Data Collection and Social Media Mining (graduate level)

Mannheim Centre for European Social Research

A Primer to Web Scraping with R (graduate level)

Recent Advances in R (graduate level)

University of Konstanz

Introduction to Stata (undergraduate level; in German)

Introduction to Questionnaire Design (undergraduate level, in German)

Computational Political Science (undergraduate level)

Data Collection in the World Wide Web (graduate level, in German)

Methods of Election Forecasting (graduate level, in German)

Introduction to Survey Methodology with R (graduate level)

service to the
profession

Journal referee for: *American Journal of Political Science*, *American Political Science Review*, *BigSurv*, *British Journal of Political Science*, *Comparative Political Studies*, *Data*, *EJP Data Science*, *Electoral Studies*, *European Political Science Review*, *GOR*, *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*, *IC2S2*, *Information, Communication & Society*, *International Journal of Forecasting*, *Journal of Elections*, *Public Opinion and Parties*, *Journal of Peace Research*, *Journal of Politics*, *Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media*, *Knowledge and Information Systems*, *Legislative Studies Quarterly*, *Nature Communications*, *Party Politics*, *PNAS*, *Political Analysis*, *Political Behavior*, *Political Communication*, *Political Science Research and Methods*, *Politische Vierteljahresschrift*, *PS: Political Science and Politics*, *Public Choice*, *Public Opinion Quarterly*, *Research & Politics*, *Review of Economics*, *Sage Open*, *Social Science Computer Review*, *Sociological Methods and Research*, *Springer Nature Social Sciences*, *Statistics, Politics and Policy*, *Survey Research Methods*, *Swiss Political Science Review*, *West European Politics*.

Grant referee for: *Leverhulme*, *Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft (DFG)*, *Swiss Data Science Center (SDSC)*,

Manuscript reviews for: *Chapman & Hall/CRC Press*, *John Wiley & Sons*.

Refereed in 2025/2026 for: *ACM CHI*, *American Political Science Review*, *British Journal of Political Science* (3), *EJP Data Science*, *Electoral Studies*, *European Journal of Political Research*, *Journal of Politics*, *JQP:DM*, *Nature Human Behaviour*, *New Media & Society*, *PNAS*, *Political Science Research & Methods*, *Politics and Governance*, *PS Political Science & Politics*, *Science*, *Scientific Reports*, *Survey Research Methods*, *West European Politics*.

Conference/workshop organizer of *Zweitstimme workshop*, 2025, *Hertie School* (co-organizer), *PolMeth Europe*, 2021, 2022 (co-organizer), *Free Speech Regulation and the Politics of Hate*, 2020, *Hertie School* (co-organizer), *Comparative Research on Political Elites*, 2020, *Hertie School* (organizer), *Political Economy in the Computational Age Workshop*, 2018, *Hertie School* (co-organizer), *General Online Research 2018*, *Cologne* (chair of track “Politics and Communication”), *Citizen and Elite Activity on Wiki-pedia Workshop*, 2017, *Hertie School* (organizer), *Media Exposure and Opinion Formation*, 2017, *Los Angeles* (co-organizer), *DVPW Working Group on Political Methodology Meeting 2016*, *Mannheim* (co-organizer).

Member of *American Political Science Association*, *European Survey Research Association*, *European Political Science Association*, *German Society for Online Research*, *German Society for Political Research*, *Society for Political Methodology*.

institutional
service

External member of the Ethikkommission (ethical review board), 2018–2022, WZB Berlin.

Member of the Research Ethics Committee, 2022–Present, Hertie School.

Member of the MDS Admissions Committee, 2021–2025, Hertie School.

Member of the IT Committee, 2019–Present, Hertie School.

Member of the PhD Board, 2018–2019, Hertie School.

supervision

3 PhD students / 66 Masters students, Hertie School,

1 Masters student, Humboldt University.

Berlin, June 2026.